



iPhone hacking spyware

QuaDreem, a lesser known spyware firm, is hacking iPhones using zero-click exploits. <https://digit.in/mar22-39>



Libmeldy drug for NHS use

Libmeldy drug is being used to treat a rare condition called MLD and costs a whopping £2.8 million! <https://digit.in/mar22-40>

Metaverse Marriages

What's next? Metaverse divorces?

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Y

es, we all get it. The metaverse is going to be the next big thing that everyone and their uncle is involved

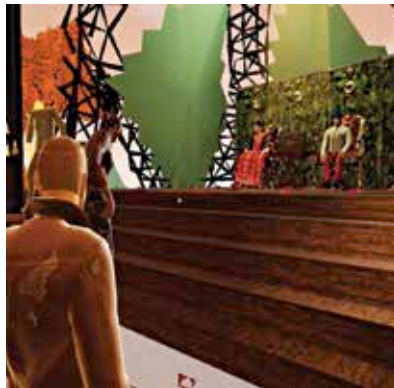
with, and soon we will be living our lives in virtual reality inside small little rooms that we never leave. Like the plots of so many sci-fi episodes and movies, the modern interpretation of the metaverse and what it will bring is being limited by the imagination of old pop culture writers. It's current avatar, the metaverse is pretty much any virtual space that you can join and meet other humans in. Applications such as VR Chat allow you to strap on a headset and meet others while playing games or doing activities. It started with concerts, because who doesn't want to attend a concert in the metaverse right? You sit in your chair, watch an avatar of a famous singer or DJ move weirdly, or watch a video of the same thing, and you press some buttons to make your own avatar 'dance' pre-programmed and very weird looking dance moves. Some of those moves even I could do better IRL (in real life).

Gaming is what the concept of metaverse is ideal for. Games are make believe, aim to be immersive, and increasingly hinge on multiplayer acceptance for collaboration and competition. And VR gaming was here quite a bit before the idea of the metaverse went mainstream.

While some things are ideal for the metaverse, some things just are not. And that brings me to the stupidest idea of all! A metaverse wedding!

At least for now (thankfully), two avatars taking seven revolutions around a make believe fire, or accepting each other in marriage in the way other religions do it is not a legal wedding. That said, if it's a popular enough idea, some politician somewhere will end up making it legal soon enough. And then what? Metaverse divorces? Can't wait!

And who in their right mind wants to go and attend a wedding in the metaverse anyway? Look I get it. Extended family from across the oceans who cannot make it to the wedding might like to watch their relatives tie the knot and be a part of the cer-



emony. I'm not heartless, I understand that bit of it. However, really close family members who want this are the exceptions here, not the rule. Besides, what's wrong with simple live feeds of weddings? They're accessible on any device, they show the actual people instead of silly avatars, and they feel a lot more special.

Asia's first wedding in the metaverse was an Indian couple, of course, since we really know how to do marriages better than anyone else! In fact, two different couples (and associated platforms) claim to be the first to have had a wedding reception in the metaverse. Sansrati and Abhijeet had a metaverse wedding on 5th February (the videos show hardly anyone attending though),

which was hosted on Yugverse, a new Indian metaverse platform. Meanwhile Janagandhini and Dinesh held a reception in a Hogwarts shaped castle inside Tardiverse, another new platform, because both are Potterheads. The Tardiverse wedding even had Janagandhini's late father attend the wedding as an avatar, which is a very heartwarming idea even to heartless old me!

Claims are made of as many as 3000 people attending the Tardiverse wedding, but we'll take such reports with a pinch of salt. And look, I get it, you want to make your wedding memorable, so you embrace gimmicks. People waste money with elaborate gestures when they propose, and our instagramming society accepts that, so why not this? So again, I get why brides and grooms do these things.

Why on *earth* would you attend one of these?!

Unless you're family, directly involved in the wedding, or making money off it somehow, weddings are a total snoozefest. Most of us only ever go so as to not offend friends or distant family members. And what's the pay off at the end for us putting ourselves through 3 to 8 hours of mind numbing boredom? Booze and food! Even if there's no booze, there's always food.

I'm supposed to go attend some stupid online version and be bored with terrible DJ-ing and insider family jokes that no one cares about or finds funny, all for the payout to be the food I already have in my own fridge? If it's someone known I will be under pressure to still give them a gift, with no food in return? And if it's someone I don't care about, well, then I don't care about them enough to not go to their real wedding, let alone a fake one!

Now if couples started ordering real-world pizza for attendees, we can reopen the discussion. Until then, keep your fake weddings to yourself please! 